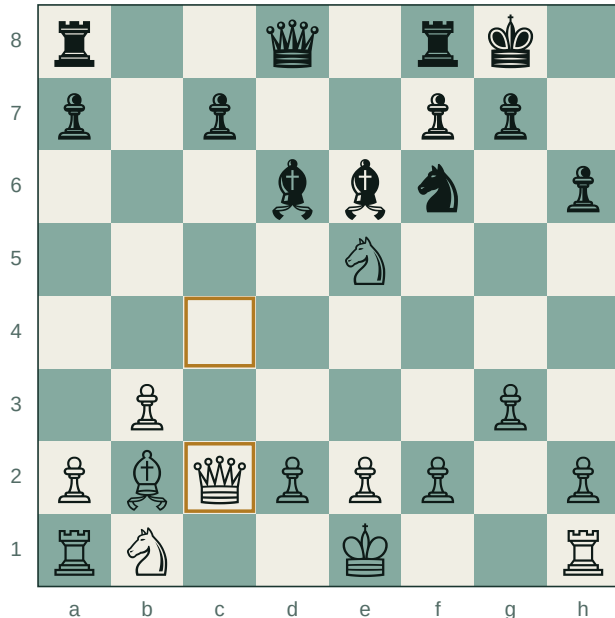


Clearance tactics: Black, move 12

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 12.Qc2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

12...Bxe5 13. Bxe5 Qd5 14. f3 Qxe5

12...Bxe5 The bishop captures the knight on e5. Recorded reply: **13.Bxe5**.

13...Qd5 The queen moves from d8 to d5. From d5 it attacks rook on h1 and bishop on e5. Recorded reply: **14.f3**.

14...Qxe5 The queen captures the bishop on e5.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 30 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: queen on c2 and rook on h1. Check for tactical protection.